

REPORT WRITING CHEAT SHEET

Mastering the "Language of Lending"

OBJECTIVE vs. SUBJECTIVE LANGUAGE

Type	Description	Examples
OBJECTIVE (Professional Standard)	Neutral, observed facts using absolute definitions	✓ "Observed roof wear and minor ponding at rear of structure" ✓ "Kitchen drywall and cabinets installed; bathroom tile incomplete" ✓ "Foundation crack on west side measuring 18 inches × 1/4 inch"
SUBJECTIVE (Rejection Trigger)	Personal opinions, vague adjectives, neighborhood comparisons	✗ "The property looks bad and old" ✗ "The home is much nicer than others on the block" ✗ "Property needs a lot of work"

THE FOUR RULES OF GOLD-STANDARD NOTES

#	Rule	What It Means	Example
1	SPECIFIC	Identify exactly where the issue is	"Northwest corner of Unit B" not "back of building"
2	OBSERVABLE	Report only what you can see	"Moisture staining visible" not "probably a leak"
3	MEASURED	Use exact counts or status	"10 out of 12 LED upgrades verified" not "most done"
4	MATCHING	Notes must mirror photos	If photo shows damage, notes must describe it

COMMON WRITING MISTAKES (Avoid These!)

- **Emotional Language:** Avoid "beautiful," "ugly," "disgusting." Use neutral: "well-maintained" or "severe deferred maintenance"
- **Speculation:** Don't guess cause of damage ("looks like a leak"). State facts: "Observed moisture staining"
- **Contradictions:** Marking "no hazards" while photo shows unsecured pool gate = major red flag
- **Repair Recommendations:** Don't say "roof needs replacement." Say "multiple shingles missing"
- **Cost Estimates:** Don't say "will cost \$5,000 to fix." Document conditions only

STANDARD NARRATIVE STRUCTURES

Occupied/Vacant: Arrival time → Address verification → Entry status → Occupancy indicators → Condition summary → Hazards → Departure time

Loss Draft: Scope reference → Line items completed → Line items incomplete → Evidence summary → Recommended action (e.g., release partial draw)

Example - Occupied: "Arrived at 123 Main St at 2:45 PM. Property appears occupied. Two vehicles present with current registration. Porch furniture in use. Mail collection active. Exterior condition good. No hazards observed. Departed 3:05 PM."

Example - Vacant: "Arrived at 456 Oak Ave at 10:30 AM. Property appears vacant. Grass overgrown (knee-high). Accumulated mail at door (20+ pieces). Interior visible showing empty. Utilities appear off. Minor siding damage on west side. Departed 10:50 AM."